



TRANSFORM FITNESS COACHING

Your Personalized Macro Guide



Built for trans, non-binary and intersex bodies

This guide explains your macro targets, how hormone therapy affects your metabolism, and how to adjust as your body evolves through transition.

UNDERSTANDING YOUR MACROS

Your macros are the three building blocks of every calorie you eat. Here's what each one does and why it matters.

PROTEIN

Builds and repairs muscle tissue. Your minimum is set based on your weight, goal, and how long you've been on hormones. This is a floor to protect muscle, not a ceiling. You can go higher if it fits your calories, but hitting this minimum is what matters most.

CARBOHYDRATES

Your body's primary fuel source for training and daily function. Carbs fill the calorie gap after protein and fats are set. More on training days for performance. Fewer on rest days in a deficit. They're flexible — this is the macro you adjust most when fine-tuning.

FATS

Essential for hormone production — especially important during HRT. Set at 25% of total calories as a floor. Supports brain function, vitamin absorption, and joint health. Don't cut below this — your body needs fats to regulate estrogen and testosterone.

CALORIE CYCLING

Eating more on training days and less on rest days optimizes body recomposition. Your calculator splits calories into training (+10%) and rest (-10%) targets.

TRAINING DAYS

+10% Calories

More carbs to fuel performance

REST DAYS

-10% Calories

Maintain deficit without losing muscle

GOAL ADJUSTMENTS

Fat Loss: -500 cal/day from TDEE — targets ~1 lb/week loss

Muscle Gain: +300 cal/day — fuels growth without excess fat

Recomp: -200 cal/day — slow cut while building muscle

Maintenance: No adjustment — sustain current composition

HOW HORMONES AFFECT YOUR METABOLISM

Standard macro calculators assume a static metabolism based on binary sex. But HRT fundamentally changes how your body burns calories, builds muscle, and stores fat. This section breaks down what happens and when.

Trans Men & AFAB Non-Binary on Testosterone

Testosterone increases your basal metabolic rate by up to 22% over 24 months. This is the most significant metabolic shift of any HRT protocol. Your body will require progressively more fuel as lean mass increases and fat distribution shifts.

TIMELINE	METABOLIC CHANGE	WHAT'S HAPPENING
Months 1-3	+1.5% per month	Initial metabolic increase. Appetite rises. Body temperature may increase. Early fat redistribution begins.
Months 3-6	+4.5 to 9%	Noticeable muscle gain with training. Metabolic rate accelerating. Calorie needs increasing meaningfully.
Months 6-12	+9 to 18%	Significant body recomposition. Fat shifting from hips/thighs to abdomen. Muscle protein synthesis elevated — protein needs are highest here.
Year 1-2+	+18 to 22%	Approaching metabolic plateau. BMR now closer to cis male range. Maintenance calories significantly higher than pre-T baseline.

PROTEIN NOTE FOR TRANS MEN

After 12 months on T, protein minimum is bumped by +0.1g/lb (capped at 0.9g/lb) to support increased muscle protein synthesis. This keeps the floor protective without overemphasizing protein.

Trans Women & AMAB Non-Binary on Estrogen

Estrogen combined with anti-androgens gradually reduces your basal metabolic rate by up to 6% over 6 months. While the percentage is smaller than testosterone's effect, it's metabolically significant — and under-eating during this period is one of the most common mistakes.

TIMELINE	METABOLIC CHANGE	WHAT'S HAPPENING
Months 1-3	-1% per month	Early metabolic slowdown. Body begins retaining more subcutaneous fat. Muscle mass slowly decreasing.
Months 3-6	-3 to 6%	Fat redistribution accelerating (breasts, hips, thighs). Metabolic rate stabilizing at new baseline. Appetite may decrease.
Month 6+	Plateau at -6%	Metabolic rate stabilized. Body composition closer to cis female ranges. Maintenance calories now permanently lower than pre-HRT.

DON'T UNDER-EAT

Your body needs adequate fuel to transition safely. Aggressive calorie cuts during early HRT can stall fat redistribution and compromise breast development. Eat at or near maintenance for the first 6 months.

NON-BINARY CONSIDERATIONS

Non-binary individuals on partial or low-dose HRT receive a partial metabolic adjustment: +9% for AFAB on low-dose T, -3% for AMAB on low-dose E. These reflect the reduced hormonal impact of non-standard dosing protocols. If you're on a full dose, the full adjustment applies regardless of identity.

INTERSEX INDIVIDUALS

For intersex individuals, the calculator uses your current hormonal environment — not a binary birth sex assumption — to calculate BMR. Options include primarily estrogenic, primarily androgenic, mixed/uncertain, or on HRT. This gives a more accurate metabolic baseline than any calculator that forces a binary choice.

Mixed/uncertain hormonal environment:

BMR uses the midpoint between male and female Mifflin-St Jeor constants (-78 instead of +5 or -161).

WHEN TO RECALCULATE YOUR MACROS

Your macros aren't set in stone. Recalculate when any of these happen:

Weight changes by 10+ lbs

Your calorie needs scale with body weight. A 10-lb shift means your protein minimum, TDEE, and macro split all need updating.

HRT milestone (3, 6, 12, 24 mo)

Each milestone brings measurable metabolic changes. The calculator's HRT adjustment curve updates at these points.

Goal changes

Switching from fat loss to muscle gain (or vice versa) changes your calorie target by 500-800 calories. Don't keep old macros for a new goal.

Activity level changes

Starting a new training program, changing jobs, or going from sedentary to active shifts your TDEE significantly.

Plateau lasting 3+ weeks

If the scale hasn't moved and measurements are flat for 3 weeks, your body has adapted. Time for new numbers.

Surgery recovery

Top surgery, bottom surgery, or any major procedure changes your activity level and recovery needs temporarily.

Stopping or starting HRT

Any change to your hormone protocol means your metabolic rate is shifting. Recalculate immediately.

5 PRACTICAL TIPS

- 1 Weigh yourself at the same time daily (morning, post-bathroom) and use a weekly average — not daily fluctuations.
- 2 Track your food for at least 2 weeks before deciding your macros aren't working. Consistency reveals patterns.
- 3 If you're on injectable T or E, expect slight water weight fluctuations around injection days. This is normal.
- 4 Take progress photos monthly. The mirror and scale lie — photos over time tell the real story.
- 5 Don't compare your timeline to anyone else's. HRT affects everyone differently.

MAKING IT WORK DAY TO DAY

Knowing your macros is step one. Here's how to actually hit them consistently.

1 Hit your protein minimum every day

Spread your protein across 3-4 meals. Front-loading protein at breakfast makes the rest of the day easier. Aim for 20-35g per meal depending on your total. If you're struggling to hit it, a protein shake counts. Going over is fine. Just make sure you clear the floor.

2 Prep your carbs around training

Eat the majority of your carbs before and after your workout. This fuels performance and speeds recovery. On rest days, shift some carb calories to fats for satiety. The total stays the same — just the timing changes.

3 Don't fear fats — but measure them

Fats are calorically dense (9 cal/g vs 4 cal/g for protein and carbs). A tablespoon of olive oil is 120 calories. Measure cooking fats and dressings until you can eyeball portions accurately. This is where most tracking errors hide.

4 Use the calorie slider for real life

The adjustment slider on your results page exists for a reason. Had a light day? Slide down 100-150 calories. Heavy training session? Slide up. The goal is a weekly average, not daily perfection.

5 Build a meal rotation

You don't need 30 different recipes. Find 4-5 meals that hit your macros and rotate them. Meal prep on Sunday. Eat the same lunch Monday through Friday. Boring works. Save variety for dinner and weekends.

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